

Question:

A mental health volunteer is interviewing locals as part of a community outreach program. A 46-year-old man discloses that he has felt sad for as long as he can remember. He feels as though his life is cursed and if something terrible can happen to him, it usually will. He has difficulty making decisions and feels hopeless. He also feels that he has had worsening suicidal ideations, guilt from past problems, energy, and concentration over the past 2 weeks. He is otherwise getting enough sleep and able to hold a job. Which of the following statement best describes this patient's condition?

Answer Choices:

- A. The patient is at risk for double depression.
- B. The patient may have symptoms of mania or psychosis.
- C. The patient is likely to show anhedonia.
- D. The patient likely has paranoid personality disorder.

Reasoning + Answer:

<think>

Finding Reasoning Paths :

- 1 . **Persistent and pervasive sadness , hope lessness , decision difficulty , and energetic hope lessness** : These symptoms suggest a mood disorder , possibly major depressive disorder (MDD) or a chronic mood disorder .
- 2 . **Difficulty making decisions , hope lessness , and suicidal ide ation** : These features align with chronic depression or dyst h y m i a .
- 3 . **Worsening symptoms over the past 2 weeks** : This could indicate a shift in the patient's mental health condition , possibly from sub threshold depressive symptoms to a diagn os able condition like M DD or dyst h y m i a .
- 4 . **Symptoms of energy , concentration problems , and sleep maintenance** : These are consistent with the presence of depression or a chronic mood disorder .
- 5 . **Social context and developmental perspective** : The patient âGŁs feelings of being cursed and hope lessness could indicate a more severe or chronic mood disorder rather than a transient or situ ational one .

Reasoning Process :

- 1 . **Initial Symptoms** : The patient has reported feeling sad and hopeless since childhood , which is a key indicator of a chronic mood disorder . His inability to make decisions and feeling like his life is cursed suggests a pervasive , long -standing mood disturbance . This is consistent with conditions like dyst h y m i a or major depressive disorder .
- 2 . **Worsening Symptoms** : The exacerbation of symptoms over the past 2 weeks indicates a possible shift from sub threshold depressive symptoms to a diagn os able mood disorder . This progression is commonly seen in chronic depression or bipolar disorder , particularly bipolar II disorder , which can present with depressive episodes .
- 3 . **Energetic Hope lessness** : The presence of increased energy coupled with hope lessness and suicidal ide ation raises the possibility of a cycling mood disorder , such as bipolar II disorder . In this condition , individuals may experience depressive episodes (which can feel energetic and active) alternating with manic or hypoman ic episodes .
- 4 . **Decision Difficulty and Su ic idal Ide ation** : These features are hallmark symptoms of major depressive disorder or bipolar disorder . The patient âGŁs feeling of hope lessness and decision difficulty are strong indicators of a mood disorder , and the suicidal ide ation suggests a significant risk of harm if not addressed .
- 5 . **Social and Developmental Context** : The patient âGŁs persistent feelings of being cursed and hope lessness over a long period suggest a chronic rather than a situ ational mood disorder . This align s with conditions like dyst h y m i a or bipolar II disorder , which often present with sub threshold symptoms for much of the time .
- 6 . **Exclusion of Other Conditions** :
 - **Major Depressive Disorder (MDD)** : This is a strong possibility given the chronicity of symptoms and the current exacerbation . However , the presence of suicidal ide ation and a history of worsening over time raises suspicion of a cycling disorder like bipolar II .
 - **Dyst h y m i a** : This is less likely due to the recent worsening of symptoms , which is more characteristic of bipolar disorder .
 - **B ip olar Disorder (Type II)** : This fits the symptoms of depressive episodes with energy and suicidal ide ation , along with a history of sub threshold mood disturbances .

Conclusion :

The patient likely has symptoms of a mood disorder , most likely ** b ip olar II disorder ** . This conclusion is supported by the combination of chronic symptoms , recent worsening of depression , energetic hope lessness , suicidal ide ation , and the developmental history of sub threshold mood disturbances .

</think>

< answer >

The patient likely has symptoms of man ia or psychosis .

</answer>